MIL-B-43404E
29 JUN 1984
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-43404D
25 March 1977

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BEEF STEW, DEHYDRATED, COOKED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers cooked, dehydrated beef stew for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

N-C-541	-	Starches, Edible
EE-B-575	-	Bouillon (Soup and Gravy Bases)
PPP-B-26	-	Bag, Plastic, (General Purpose)
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-C-843	-	Cushioning Material, Cellulosic
PPP-C-1797	-	Cushioning Material, Resilient, Low Density, Unicellular, Polypropylene Foam
PPP-T-60	-	Tape: Packaging, Waterproof

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Center, Natick, MA 01760 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8940

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Non-perishable Subsistence Items, General Specification for

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595 - Colors

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots
U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Chief, Processed Products Branch, Fruit and Vegetable Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 882 - Tensile Properties of Thin Plastic Sheeting

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

THE UNITED STATES PHARMACOPOEIAL CONVENTION (USP)

Pharmacopoeia of the United States

(Application for copies should be addressed to the United States Pharmacopoeial Convention, Inc., 12601 Twinbrook Parkway, Rockville, MD 20852.)

AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 251 Kearny Street, No. 410, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, Washington, DC 20418.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1 and 6.2).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-flavors, off-odors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Beef. Beef shall be the only meat ingredient used and shall be from steers, heifers, or cows and shall be derived from any combination of the following recognizable primal and sub-primal cuts (shoulder clods, chuck rolls, ribs, ribeyes, trimmed full loins, trimmed short loins, strip loins, sirloins, top sirloin butts, rounds, top rounds, knuckles, and bottom rounds (with heel out)) which qualify as U.S. grade good or better. Recognizable cuts are those which, when compared to IMPS cuts, have no more than a minor amount of lean, fat, or bone removed or included form an adjacent cut. All suitable lean meat shall be used except tenderloins may be excluded at the option of the contractor. The beef shall be in the fresh chilled state and shall be in excellent condition, i.e., exposed lean and fat surfaces shall be of a color and bloom normally associated with the class and cut of meat, and typical of meat which has been properly stored and handled; cut surfaces and naturally exposed lean surfaces shall show no more than slight darkening or discoloration due to dehydration, aging, or microbial activity; the fat shall show no more than a

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

very slight discoloration due to oxidation or microbial activity; no odors foreign to fresh meat shall be present; changes in color and odor characteristically associated with vacuum-packaged meat in excellent condition shall be acceptable; and there shall be no evidence of freezing, defrosting or mishandling.

3.2.1.1 Boning and trimming. The fresh chilled beef shall be boned and trimmed to remove objectionable material such as a bone, cartilage, heavy connective tissue, etc. The boneless trimmed meat shall meet the limitations specified in table I and table II.

3.2.1.2 Handling and storage of raw meat. Handling and storage of raw meat prior to processing into the finished product shall be in accordance with the following requirements:

a. Bone-in beef shall be maintained at a temperature not exceeding 50°F at all times prior to boning and trimming.

b. Holding boned and trimmed beef in the fresh chilled state for up to 4 days is permitted provided that the beef is maintained at an internal temperature not higher than 40°F.

c. Beef shall be in excellent condition at all times.

d. Beef shall not be frozen at any time prior to coarse grinding or flake cutting.

3.2.2 Carrots. Carrots shall be fresh or frozen. Fresh carrots shall be washed, peeled, sorted, trimmed and blanched in accordance with good commercial practice. Frozen carrots shall comply with the requirements for U.S. Grade B or better of U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Carrots. The carrots shall be mechanically diced with dice settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch.

3.2.3 Onion powder. Onion powder shall comply with the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products for Standard grade or better onion powder.

3.2.4 Onions, minced. Minced onions shall comply with the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products for standard or better minced onions.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.5 Peas, frozen. Frozen peas shall meet the requirements of U.S. Standards for Grades of Frozen Peas, U.S. Grade B or better. Peas shall be slit or perforated to improve rehydration characteristics.

3.2.6 Potatoes. Potatoes shall be a variety of excellent processing qualities and high density or specific gravity. Varieties with these characteristics include Russet, Burbank, Kennebec, Monona, and Norchips. Dehydrated or dehydro-frozen potatoes shall not be used.

3.2.7 Salt. Salt shall be white, refined, sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agent. Iodized salt shall not be used.

3.2.8 Soup and gravy base, beef flavor. Beef flavored soup and gravy bases shall comply with type I, class I, style A of EE-B-575.

3.2.9 Caramel color. Caramel color shall meet the requirements of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.10 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the mature berries of Piper nigrum L., from which the outer covering or outer and inner coverings have been removed. The volatile oil content shall not be less than 1.0 mL/100 g.

3.2.11 Starch, freeze-thaw stable. Freeze-thaw stable starch shall form a smooth, short textured, heavy bodied, almost clear aqueous solution. The flavor shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starchy taste. The starch shall comply with MIL-STD-900.

3.2.12 Nitrogen. Nitrogen shall be U.S. Pharmacopoeia grade and shall be water or liquid nitrogen pumped.

3.2.13 Water. Water used for formulation and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.3 Preparation and processing.

3.3.1 Beef preparation.

a. Preparation of beef logs. Beef logs shall be prepared as follows:

1. Coarse grinding and flake-cutting processes. The boned and trimmed meat shall be ground once through a plate having holes 1 to 1-1/2 inches in diameter for coarse grinding or flake-cut by passing it once through a

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Urschel Comitrol Comminutor equipped with a size 3J030750 or 3J060705 head or equivalent. The temperature of the beef shall not exceed 40°F at the end of coarse grinding or flake-cutting. Dry ice may be used in appropriate amounts to control temperature during coarse grinding or flake-cutting.

2. Fat content. The fat content of the coarse ground or flake cut meat shall be 12 to 21 percent.

3. Mixing. The coarse ground or flake-cut meat shall be mixed with 0.5 percent salt until the meat becomes moderately tacky then immediately stuffed tightly into suitable casings. The temperature of the meat shall not exceed 42°F at the end of mixing and stuffing into casings. (See 3.7 for time and temperature limitations).

b. Cooking of beef logs. The beef logs shall be cooked within 24 hours after stuffing into casings to an internal temperature of at least 150°F but not higher than 160°F. (See 3.7 for time and temperature limitations).

c. Dicing of cooked beef logs. The cooked beef logs shall be cooled to a uniform temperature of 25° to 30°F prior to mechanically dicing. The dicer shall be set at approximately 1/2 by 1/2 by 1/4 inch. After dicing the beef shall show a minimum of 75 percent recognizable dices. (See 3.7 for time and temperature limitations).

3.3.2 Potato preparation. The potatoes shall be washed, sorted, peeled, trimmed to remove defects and mechanically diced with dicer settings at approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 3/8 inch. They shall be processed according to good commercial practice.

3.3.3 Stew formulation. The beef stew shall be prepared in accordance with the following formula:

	Percent by weight
Beef, cooked, diced	25.0
Potatoes, raw, diced	21.0
Peas, slit or perforated	8.0
Carrots, raw, diced	8.0
Water	34.9
Starch, freeze-thaw stable	0.75
Seasoning mix	2.35

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Seasoning mix	Percent by weight
Soup and gravy base, beef flavored	49.4
Salt	12.8
Onion powder	3.4
Pepper, white	1.3
Onions, dehydrated	31.9
Caramel color	1.2

3.3.4 Stew preparation and cooking. The potatoes shall be cooked in water until just done and the dice edges are firm then rinsed with cold water. If the carrots and peas have been blanched before refreezing, they may be used without precooking otherwise they shall be blanched prior to addition to the product. Prepare a slurry with the starch and water, add the seasoning mix and heat to 180°F. Add beef, peas and carrots to mixture and heat to 140°F. Add precooked potatoes and heat to 160°F. Any process which will produce an equivalent product may be acceptable. (See 3.7 for time and temperature limitations).

3.3.5 Freezing. The prepared product shall be spread on dehydrator trays and cooled immediately, placed in a freezer within 4 hours after cooking, and frozen to 0°F or below within 6 hours after placing in the freezer.

3.3.6 Dehydration. The product shall be freeze dehydrated at an absolute pressure not to exceed 1.5 millimeters of mercury and at a product temperature as indicated by suitable instruments, not to exceed 150°F. If the platen temperature is maintained at 155°F or below with radiant heating, the product temperature may be disregarded. After dehydration is completed, the pressure shall be equalized to atmospheric level with nitrogen and the product shall be packaged immediately as specified in 5.1. In no case shall more than 16 hours elapse between the time the chamber is opened and the time the product is completely packaged. During the interim the product shall be adequately protected from oxygen and moisture by either holding under a nitrogen atmosphere with 2.0 percent or less oxygen, or under a vacuum of at least 27 inches for the entire period. If vacuum is used, it shall be broken with nitrogen.

3.3.7 Time-temperature limitations. The beef logs and dices shall be handled so as to comply with the following limitations:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

1. Maximum holding temperature of uncooked beef logs prior to cooking:

a. If beef logs are chilled	40°F
b. If beef logs are frozen	0°F

2. Maximum holding time of uncooked beef logs prior to cooking:

a. If beef logs are chilled	24 hours
b. If beef logs are frozen	20 days 1/

3. Maximum holding temperature of cooked beef logs:

a. If beef logs are chilled	30°F
b. If beef logs are frozen	0°F

4. Maximum holding time between cooking and dicing:

a. If beef logs are chilled	24 hours
b. If beef logs are frozen 2/	14 days

5. Maximum holding temperature of cooked diced beef prior to use in the product:

a. If beef dices are chilled	40°F
b. If beef dices are frozen	0°F 3/

6. Maximum holding time between dicing and use in the product:

a. If the diced beef is chilled/tempered	4 hours
b. If the diced beef is frozen	7 days

7. Maximum temperature of beef stew between preparation and freeze dehydrated 0°F

8. Maximum time between placing beef stew in freezer and start of freeze dehydration 5 days

1/ If beef logs are frozen in the uncooked state they shall not be frozen after cooking and shall be used in the product within 24 hours after chilling for dicing.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2/ Cooked beef logs shall be placed in a freezer within 4 hours after completion of cooking and frozen to an internal temperature of 0°F or below within 72 hours after placing in the freezer.

3/ Beef dices prepared from beef logs that have been frozen prior to cooking or cooked beef logs that have been frozen prior to dicing shall not be frozen. They shall be used in the product within 4 hours after dicing.

3.4 Finished product. The finished product shall comply with the following physical characteristics:

Dehydrated product:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as but not limited to dirt, glass, or paint.

b. There shall be no foreign colors such as but not limited to black or purple.

c. There shall be no evidence of incomplete dehydration such as wet or soft spots.

d. There shall be no evidence of faulty dehydration such as glazed surface areas measuring more than 0.5 inch in any dimension or dark colored cores of any dimension.

e. Moisture content of the dehydrated product shall not exceed 2.0 percent.

f. The bacterial content shall not exceed a standard plate count of 75,000 per gram in four of five samples and not greater than 150,000 per gram in any sample.

g. The E coli count shall be less than 3 per gram in at least four out of five samples and shall not exceed 20 per gram in any sample.

Rehydrated product:

h. When rehydrated in hot water (180° to 200°F) using the ratio of 13 ounces of water to 5-1/4 ounces of the beef stew for 10 minutes, the product shall show complete water penetration through all

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

particles. However, gristle and similar materials in the meat do not necessarily rehydrate properly and such materials shall not be considered as evidence of incomplete rehydration. 1/

i. The rehydrated product shall possess flavor, odor, and texture considered normal for frozen and heated beef stew. There shall be no scorched, burnt, or foreign flavors or odors.

j. When rehydrated as in h. above, the product shall show distinct pieces and dice of meat, potatoes, and carrots and whole peas. It shall not be a mass of indistinguishable materials.

1/ Up to, but not exceeding 2.0 ounces of additional hot water (180°F to 200°F) may be added to aid in rehydration and improve consistency of the product.

3.4.1 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.5 Plant qualification. The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.6 Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and acceptance service. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of acceptance service necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document. The cost of grading and acceptance services performed by the USDA involving inspection, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Beef examination. All beef shall be examined in either the bone-in or boneless state for conformance to the condition and cut requirements in 3.2.1. Cuts initially examined in the boneless state shall be in the form of whole boneless recognizable cuts. Any nonconforming beef shall be rejected.

4.5.1.2 Boned and trimmed beef examination. After boning and trimming and prior to any further processing or to any freezing, the beef shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size expressed in terms of pounds shall be declared to the AMS agent by the contractor. However, the AMS agent reserves the right to declare as a lot any portion of a declared lot, if, in his or her opinion, that portion may be out of compliance with any requirement. The sample unit shall be a minimum of 12 pounds of adjacent boneless beef. The sample size shall be as specified in table I. If all or a portion of the sample unit falls within a larger cut, the entire cut shall be examined. Failure of the beef to meet the acceptance criteria as indicated in table I shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Except for beef rejected because of freezing, defrosting, or presence of off-condition, the beef may be reworked by the contractor and reoffered for examination. For reexamination, the sampling plan used shall be the one in table I designed for the next larger lot size than the one under which the lot was initially rejected. Beef shall not be reexamined more than one time.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE I. Sampling plan for boned and trimmed beef

Lot size (pounds)	Sample size (No. of sample units)	Defect categories Major AC	Major RE	Minor AC	Minor RE
500 or less	13	1	2	3	4
501 to 1200	20	2	3	5	6
1201 to 3200	32	3	4	7	8
3201 to 10,000	50	5	6	10	11
10,001 to 35,000	80	7	8	14	15
Reinspection lots of 10,001 to 35,000	125	10	11	21	22

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects

Category		Defect 1/ 2/
Major	Minor	
151		Presence of lymph gland measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.
	201	Presence of lymph gland measuring more than 0.5 inch but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension.
152		Presence of blood clot measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.
	202	Presence of blood clot measuring 0.3 inch or more but less than 0.5 inch in any dimension.
153		Presence of bruise measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects (cont'd)

Category		Defect 1/ 2/
Major	Minor	
	203	Presence of bruise measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in any dimension.
154		Presence of bone measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.
155		Presence of cartilage measuring 0.5 inch or more in any dimension.
156		Presence of backstrap or other ligament measuring 1.0 inch or more in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).
	204	Presence of backstrap or other ligament measuring 0.5 inch or more but less than 1.0 inch in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).
157		Presence of heavy connective tissue (for example, on the surface of the outside round adjacent to the knuckle, along the skin surface of the strip loin, or the gracilis membrane) measuring 2.0 square inches or more.
	205	Presence of heavy connective tissue (for example, on the surface of the outside round adjacent to the knuckle, along the skin surface of the strip loin, or the gracilis membrane) measuring 0.5 square inches or more but less than 2.0 square inches.
	206	Presence of heavy connective tissue on lower edge of short plate or flank.
	207	Presence of heavy connective (abdominal tunic) tissue on the flank measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects (cont'd)

Category		Defect 1/ 2/
Major	Minor	
	208	Presence of membranous portion of diaphragm or membranous covering from skirt, flank or abdominal section of short plate measure 3 square inches or more.
158		Presence of knuckle cover.
159		Presence of kidney, pizzle eye, pre-pubic tendon, thymus gland or hanging tender measuring 1.0 inch or more in one dimension and 0.2 inch or more in a second dimension (when measured at right angles to each other).
	209	Presence of kidney, pizzle eye, pre-pubic tendon, hanging tender or thymus gland measuring less than 1.0 inch in longest dimension.
	210	Presence of calcified (scratchy) periosteum measuring 2.0 square inches or more.
	211	Presence of shank, clod, knuckle, or bottom (outside) round with tendinous end showing less than 75 percent lean tissue on a cross-sectional cut surface.
	212	Presence of dehydrated surface measuring 1.0 square inch or more.
	213	Presence of discolored meat (including blood discolored neck meat) measuring 1.0 square inch or more.
	214	Presence of exposed major blood vessel measuring 1.0 inch or more in any dimension.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Boned and trimmed beef defects (cont'd)

Category		Defect 1/ 2/
Major	Minor	
	215	Presence of cod, udder, kidney, or pelvic fat.

1/ Acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (for example: glass, dirt, insect parts, hair wood, metal) shall be determined by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Program employee. The presence of any product not in excellent condition shall cause rejection of the involved lot.

2/ Evidence of freezing or defrosting or presence of any off-condition, (including but not restricted to being off-odor, slightly sticky, gassy, rancid, or sour, or showing discoloration) shall cause rejection of the involved lot.

4.5.1.3 Other ingredient examination. Conformance of ingredients to identity and condition requirements shall be determined by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade certificates, invoices, certificates of analysis, or other valid documents. In addition, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically as necessary to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient lot or of any involved product.

4.5.1.4 Material certification. Material listed below shall be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of conformance to the indicated requirements.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Material	Requirement	Requirement paragraph
Polyethylene for bags	Material identification	5.1.1
	Material thickness	5.1.1
Baseboard (when used)	Material identification	5.1.1.2
	Thickness	5.1.1.2
	Color	5.1.1.2
Laminated bag material	Material identification	5.1.2
	Films and foil thickness	5.1.2
	Construction	5.1.2
	Color	5.1.2

4.5.1.5 Polyethylene bag examination. The unfilled bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table III. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one unfilled bag. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE III. Unfilled polyethylene bag defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
151		Dimensions not as specified (see 5.1.1) 1/
152		Not type or material specified
	201	Tape missing or not placed over ears (when applicable see 5.1.1)
153		Tear, hole, or open seam
154		Not clean

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE III. Unfilled polyethylene bag defects (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	Applicable to baseboard (when used):
	202	Not dimension specified
	203	Corners not rounded

1/ Bag dimensions are inside dimensions exclusive of seams or seals. Deviations from bag dimensions due to seal creep, or seams not being parallel with each other shall be scored as a defect.

4.5.1.6 Polyethylene bag seal strength testing. The unfilled bags shall be tested for seal strength in accordance with Method B of ASTM D 882 using a uniform testing speed of 10 inches per minute. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample size shall be the number of bags indicated by inspection level S-1. Two adjacent specimens shall be cut from the sealed bottom of each bag in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound. The average seal strength of the seal shall be calculated by averaging the strengths of the two test specimens cut from that seal. Any test specimen failing to meet the individual test specimen seal strength requirement specified in 5.1.1 or any seal failing to meet the average seal strength requirement specified in 5.1.1 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.1.7 Laminated bag examination. The unfilled bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table IV. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one unfilled bag. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Unfilled laminated bag defects

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
151		Not size specified
152		Heat seal dimensions on three edges not as specified
153		Tear, hole, or open seal
154		Not clean
155		Color not as specified
156		Required labeling missing, incorrect, or illegible
157		Not material specified
158		Individual bags that stick together or that tear when separated.
159		Evidence of delamination 1/
	201	Tear notch missing
	202	Tear notch not located as specified
	203	Depth of tear notch not as specified

1/ Delamination shall be scored as a defect except delamination of outer ply when located in the seal area 1/16 inch or further from food product edge of seal. Bags exhibiting this type of delamination shall be tested manually by flexing the delaminated area 10 times. The area of delamination shall be held between the thumb and forefinger of each hand with both thumbs and forefingers touching each other. The delaminated area shall then be rapidly flexed by rotating both hands in alternating clockwise - counter-clockwise directions. Care shall be exercised when flexing delaminated area near the tear notches to avoid tearing the bag material. After

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

flexing, the separated outer ply shall be grasped between the thumb and forefinger and gently lifted toward the food product edge of the seal. If the separated area is too small to be held between thumb and forefinger, a number two stylus shall be inserted into the delaminated area and a gentle lifting force applied against the outer ply. If separation of the outer ply can be made to extend to less than 1/16 inch from the product edge of the seal with no discernible resistance to the gentle lifting, the bag shall be rejected.

4.5.1.8 Laminated bag seal strength testing. The unfilled bags shall be tested for seal strength in accordance with Method A or B of ASTM D 882 using a uniform testing speed of 10 to 12 inches per minute. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample size shall be the number of bags indicated by inspection level S-1. Two adjacent specimens shall be cut from each of the three sealed sides of each bag in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound. The average seal strength of each seal shall be calculated by averaging the strengths of the two test specimens cut from that seal. Any test specimen failing to meet the individual test specimen seal strength requirement specified in 5.1.2 or any seal failing to meet the average seal strength requirement specified in 5.1.2 shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, time and temperature limitation, and unit packing requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.2.1 In-process testing for fat content. Four 1-pound samples shall be selected at random from the day's production of raw coarse ground beef or flaked beef, as applicable. Each of the four samples shall be tested for fat content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. If the fat content of one or more samples is greater than the limit specified in 3.3.1, the lot of ground or flaked beef or any product made therefrom shall be rejected.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.5.3 Net weight inspection. The net weight of the filled and sealed laminated bags shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty laminated bag and an empty polyethylene bag. Any individual net weight of less than 5 ounces shall be scored as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 1/8 ounce. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 5-1/4 ounces.

4.5.4 Bag vacuum examination. The filled and sealed bags shall be visually examined for a proper vacuum level not less than 48 hours after filling and sealing. The sealed bags shall continue to exhibit moderate adherence to the surface contours of the contents when a pulling force is applied at the center of each side seal. This force shall be applied by holding each side seal between thumb and forefinger of each hand, simultaneously exerting a slight pull with both hands. Any evidence of loss of vacuum shall be considered a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be I, except that the sample size shall not be less than 200 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65. Product in bags exhibiting a loss of vacuum may be repacked if it has been protected from oxygen and moisture by being held under a vacuum of at least 27 inches of mercury or in an atmosphere of nitrogen containing 2 percent or less oxygen. If vacuum is used, it shall be broken with nitrogen. The product must be repacked and resealed (with subsequent re-examination) within 48 hours of original sealing.

4.5.5 Filled and sealed laminated bag examination. The filled and sealed laminated bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table V. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be I, except that the sample size shall not be less than 200, and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65 for major defects and 2.5 for minor defects.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE V. Filled and sealed laminated bag defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
151		Not formed as specified
152		Not clean
153		Tear, hole, or open seal
154		Closure seal not produced by specified method
155		Evidence of delamination 2/
156		Closure seal width not as specified
157		Closure or top seal extends into or below tear notch
158		Bag has foreign odor
159		Required labeling missing, incorrect, illegible, or that smudges
160		Color not as specified
161		Inner bag caught in closure seal making removal of contents impossible without rendering the laminated bag unfit for rehydration of contents
	201	Inner bag caught in closure seal, but contents can be removed without making laminated bag unfit for rehydration of contents

1/ Any evidence of insect or rodent infestation shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2/ Delamination shall be scored as a defect except delamination of outer ply when located in the seal area 1/16 inch or further from food product edge of seal. Bags exhibiting this type of delamination shall be tested manually by flexing the delaminated area 10 times. The area of delamination shall be held between the thumb and forefinger of each hand with both thumbs and forefingers touching each other. The delaminated area shall then be rapidly flexed by rotating both hands in alternating clockwise - counter-clockwise directions. Care shall be exercised when flexing delaminated area near the tear notches to avoid tearing the bag material. After flexing, the separated outer ply shall be grasped between the thumb and forefinger and gently lifted toward the food product edge of the seal. If the separated area is too small to be held between thumb and forefinger, a number two stylus shall be inserted into the delaminated area and a gentle lifting force applied against the outer ply. If separation of the outer ply can be made to extend to less than 1/16 inch from the product edge of the seal with no discernible resistance to the gentle lifting, the bag shall be rejected.

4.5.6 Product examination. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in table VI. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be the contents of one filled and sealed bag. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

TABLE VI. Product examination 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	Applicable to dehydrated product
151	Evidence of incomplete dehydration such as damp or soggy areas.
152	Presence of glazed surface areas measuring more than 0.5 inch in any dimension.
153	Presence of burned areas as indicated by a black spot greater than 0.5 inch in any dimension.
154	Presence of dark colored cores of any dimension.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VI. Product examination 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	Applicable to rehydrated product 3/
155	Incomplete water penetration through all particles. 4/
156	Product does not show distinct peas, dices of meat, potato or carrots (i.e., the product is a mass of indistinguishable materials).

1/ The presence of any foreign material (e.g. glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal, etc.), foreign odor or flavor (e.g. burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.) or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. (This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by an AMS agent.)

3/ Rehydrated in 13 to 15 fluid ounces of hot water (180° to 200°F) for 10 minutes.

4/ Dry or callous-like areas attributable to gristle and similar material shall not be considered as defects.

4.5.7 Laminated bag closure seal strength testing. The filled and sealed bags shall be tested for seal strength in accordance with Method A or B of ASTM D 882 using a uniform testing speed of 10 or 12 inches per minute. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample size shall be the number of bags indicated by inspection level S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5. Two adjacent specimens shall be cut from the closure seal of each bag in the sample. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 pound. The average seal strength of each seal shall be calculated by averaging the strengths of the two test specimens cut from that

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

seal. Any test specimen failing to meet the individual test specimen closure seal strength requirement specified in 5.1.2.1 or any seal failing to meet the average closure seal strength requirements specified in 5.1.2.1 shall be scored as a defect.

4.5.8 Moisture content testing. The finished product shall be tested for moisture content in accordance with Moisture - Drying in Vacuum method in the Meat section of the Meat and Meat Products chapter in the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists except that the temperature time cycle shall be modified by using a temperature of 70°C for 16 hours at a pressure of 13 kPa. The results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result not conforming to the requirement in 3.4 shall be considered a defective. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed laminated bag. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of percent defective, shall be 1.5.

4.5.9 Microbiological testing. Five filled and sealed bags of finished product shall be selected at random from the lot regardless of lot size. The contents of each sample bag shall be microbiologically tested, as applicable, in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Microbiological Methods: Section: Examination of Frozen, Chilled, Precooked, or Prepared Foods-Official First Action. The diluent shall be added to each sample of dry product and allowed to stand for 15 minutes before the blending of that sample. Continue as directed by AOAC. Any test failure shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Any of the following results shall be considered a test failure.

a. Any of the five samples has aerobic plate count of greater than 150,000 per gram.

b. Two or more of the five samples have an aerobic plate count greater than 75,000 per gram.

c. Any of the five samples has confirmed E. coil count of greater than 20 per gram.

d. Two or more of the five samples have a confirmed E. coli count equal to or greater than 3 per gram.

4.5.10 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in construction, packing, closure, and reinforcement in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the following additional defects shall apply:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Major

Not snug-fitting or evidence of bulging.
Pad or liner missing.
National stock number, item description, contract number, or date of pack markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Fiberboard box or liner or top and bottom pads not material specified.

Minor

Other required markings missing, incorrect, or illegible.
Less than 45 unit packs in container.
Arrangement not as specified.
Excess unit pack material not maintained in the flat (unfolded) state.
Dunnage material not placed as specified.
Dimensions of dunnage material not as specified.

4.5.11 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with MIL-L-35078 and the applicable specification sheet for the type and class of load specified.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A. The product shall be filled in polyethylene bags as specified in 5.1.1. These shall then be unit packed in laminated plastic-foil bags as specified in 5.1.2.

5.1.1 Polyethylene bags. A net weight of 5-1/4 ounces of the product shall be filled into a 0.005 inch thick ± 10 percent polyethylene bag made in accordance with type I bags of PPP-B-26, except that the bag shall be made from food grade polyethylene. A net weight tolerance of minus 1/4 ounce is permitted provided that the average net weight of the bags in any lot is not less than 5-1/4 ounces. If medium density polyethylene (0.926 to 0.940.g/cm^3) is used, a minimum thickness of 0.003 inch is acceptable. The bags shall not impart any undesirable odor or flavor to the product and shall be approved by the Food and Drug Administration for food items. The seal strength, of the manufacturer's seal shall be not less than 5 pounds per linear inch (lot average) when tested in accordance with 4.5.1.6 with no individual unit evidencing a seal strength specimen of less than 4 pounds per linear inch. The inside dimensions of the bag shall be 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 by 8 inches ± 1/8 inch in each dimension with the open end of the bag having the 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inch dimensions. After filling, the end panels of the bag (corresponding to the 3-1/2 inch dimension) shall be folded in to form gussets, and the bag shall be

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

closed by folding over its open end. Where required by the bulkiness of the product, the bulk of the contents within the bag shall be compressed to a depth of not more than 2-1/4 inches by applying a constant uniform pressure over the entire top surface of the product. The filled bag with its open top folded over to prevent spillage of the product shall be inserted to the bottom of the laminated plastic-foil bag specified in 5.1.2. Alternatively, in lieu of polyethylene bags conforming to type I of PPP-B-26, bags made in accordance with type II of PPP-B-26, with inside dimensions of 9 inches by 8 inches (± 1/8 inch in each dimension) with the open end of the bag having the 9 inch dimension, may be used. The material and seal strength shall be as specified for type I bags. When type II bags are used, they shall be formed over a baseboard on a mandrel as specified in 5.1.1.1 before filling. While the bag is positioned on the mandrel, the two bag ears shall be taped down over a 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inch base-board constructed in accordance with 5.1.1.2. An 8 inch long strip of 1 inch wide tape complying with type III, class 2 of PPP-T-60, shall be applied across both ears to fasten them securely to the baseboard.

5.1.1.1 Mandrel. The mandrel face shall be 5-3/8 by 3-3/8 inches and the height shall be not less than 12 inches. All corners and edges of the mandrel shall be rounded and all surfaces finished to prevent damage to the bag material.

5.1.1.2 Baseboard. The baseboard shall be constructed from unbleached and uncoated solid sulfate or sulfite paperboard not less than 0.022 inch thick. Alternatively, the baseboard may be constructed from 0.022 inch thick food grade paperboard made from recycled fibers. If paperboard made from recycled fibers is used, it shall be natural color ranging from brown to grey. The baseboard shall be 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inches (± 1/8 inch) and shall have all corners rounded to form a smooth contour.

5.1.2 Laminated plastic-foil bag. The bag shall be fabricated from a material consisting of 0.0025 inch thick ionomer or polyethylene film ± 10 percent, laminated or extrusion coated to 0.00035 inch thick aluminum foil ± 10 percent, laminated or extrusion coated on the plain side to 0.001 inch ± 20 percent thick polyester or Nylon 6. The polyester or Nylon 6 shall be bonded to the aluminum foil by hot extruding 10 pounds per ream of polyethylene ± 10 percent between the laminae. The exterior (polyester or Nylon 6) surface of the material shall be colored overall with a color in the number ranges from 34052 to 34108 inclusive, or 20045, 20062 or 30045 of FED-STD-595. Reverse printing of the exterior layer will be acceptable and any luster contributed by the polyester or Nylon 6 lamina (external) shall not be considered as affecting the color gloss. The combined sheet material shall be provided with sufficient slip characteristics to prevent blocking of interior surfaces of the bag and shall show no evidence of delamination before or after heat sealing. The

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

laminated material shall be suitably formulated for food products in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder. The interior surface of the laminated material shall not impart any undesirable odor or flavor to the product. The bag shall be a flat style bag having the inside dimensions of either 6 by 16 inches ± 1/8 inch or 6 by 10-5/8 inches (± 1/8 inch in each dimension), and shall be heat sealed on three edges with 3/8 inch wide seals (± 1/8 inch). One side of the open end of the bag may be provided with a 1/4 inch (± 1/16 inch) extended or foldover lip to facilitate opening and filling. The laminated bag material shall have an average seal strength of not less than 6 pounds per linear inch with no individual seal strength being less than 5 pounds per linear inch when tested in accordance with 4.5.1.8. A "V" or "C" (half round) shaped tear notch, cut not to exceed 1/8 inch in depth (- 1/16 inch) shall be made in both side seals 1-1/2 inches (± 1/8 inch) from the open (unsealed) end of the bag. The distance between the inside edge of the tear notch and the inside edge of the seal shall be at least 3/16 inch. The unit pack shall be closed as specified in 5.1.2.1.

5.1.2.1 Closure of filled laminated plastic-foil bag. The filled laminated bag shall be evacuated and closed by heat sealing the open end in a vacuum of not less than 28 inches of mercury as registered on a vacuum gauge on the closing machine. Not less than 24 hours or more following the unit pack closing operation, an examination shall be made of each unit pack to determine compliance with the vacuum requirements (see 4.5.4). The closure seal shall be not less than 1/4 inch nor more than 1/2 inch wide and shall have an average seal strength of not less than 6 pounds per linear inch when tested in accordance with 4.5.7. Alternatively, an optional double seal may be applied to close the bags. The double closure seal shall be at least 5/16 inch wide and shall be above the tear notch and shall have an average seal strength of 6 pounds per linear inch, and no individual specimen shall have a strength of less than 5 pounds per linear inch when tested in accordance with 4.5.7. If thermal impulse sealing is used for the closure seal, a seal width of not less than 1/8 inch is required and shall be above the tear notches. The unit pack shall be labeled with a pressure-sensitive label in accordance with 5.4, subsequent to the closing operation. Unit packs which are improperly sealed or fail to main-tain vacuum after sealing may be resealed or the contents may be placed in a new laminated plastic-foil bag and resealed.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level C.

5.2.1 Level C (for shipment of flexibly packed food to the ration assembler). Forty-five filled and sealed unit packs, preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box with liner, constructed and closed by Method II in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, variety SW, grade 175, of PPP-B-636. In addition, top and bottom pads constructed of

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

the same material as the shipping container shall be used in packing. The unit packs shall be packed flat or nested in three layers of 15 unit packs each. Each unit pack shall be packed with its excess material maintained in the flat (unfolded) state. Dunnage material not less than 1/8 inch thick conforming to type II, class B of PPP-C-843, or, alternatively, dunnage material not less than 1/16 inch thick conforming to PPP-C-1797 shall be placed between each of the three layers of unit packs and in the bottom and top of the cases to minimize movement of each individual packet. The length and width of the pieces of dunnage material shall be not less than the length and width of the shipping container.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product packed as specified in 5.2.1 shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Unit pack, (food packets). Each unit pack shall have labeling that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. The label shall be pressure-sensitive and colored a dull non-reflective color other than white, and all printing thereon shall be black, boldface, legible type with indelible ink. The label shall be applied to one face of the bag with sufficient pressure to assure its adherence to the packet. The labels shall contain the following information:

CAUTION - INNER BAG IS OPEN. REMOVE IT CAREFULLY
HOLDING OUTER BAG UPRIGHT TO AVOID SPILLING
CONTENTS.

BEEF STEW DEHYDRATED COOKED

TEAR BAG OPEN AT NOTCHES. EXTRACT FOOD BAG. ADD
1/2 CANTEEN CUP HOT OR COLD WATER TO FOOD IN BAG.
LET SOAK 5-10 MINUTES. ADD MORE WATER IF DESIRED.
MAY BE EATEN DRY.

NET WT. 5-1/4 OZ.

NAME AND ADDRESS OF PRODUCER.

USDA INSPECTION MARKING (AS APPLICABLE).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.4.1.1 Alternative printing on packet bags. Alternatively, the above information may be printed directly on the bag with indelible black ink. When printing is applied directly to the bag it shall be located in an area that will permit the printing to be legible after vacuum sealing.

5.4.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.3 Unit load marking. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4 and 6.2).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.4.1 and 6.2).
d. Type and class of unit load when unit loading is required (see 5.3).

6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Changes from the previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-0361

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1. The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8. In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.
2. The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.
3. The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-B-43404E	1984 June 29

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
BEEF STEW, DEHYDRATED, COOKED

4. NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)*

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (if applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON/DSN
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	508-651-4501	256-4501
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: STRNC-WTP Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T21:20Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.